

TRAVEL · BOOKING APP

Wanderlust — from daydream to booked in a few taps

A travel-stay app that makes discovery inspiring and booking effortless — surfacing places you'll love and collapsing the path to a confident “Book Now”.

ROLE

UX / UI Designer

TIMELINE

6 weeks

PLATFORM

iOS & Android

TOOLS

Figma · Maze · FigJam

01

The Problem

Booking a trip should feel exciting — instead it's exhausting. Endless listings, uninspiring grids, and prices that jump at checkout push travelers to open ten tabs, compare endlessly, and abandon the booking entirely.

PROBLEM STATEMENT

How might we help travelers discover stays they'll love and book them confidently — without decision fatigue or price surprises?

38

sites the avg. traveler
visits before booking

#1

abandonment cause:
surprise fees at checkout

2s

to lose interest in a boring
listing grid

Goals & Success Metrics



Inspire, then filter

Lead with curated, visual discovery — not a spreadsheet of rooms.



Build trust on the detail page

Photos, ratings, amenities and an honest total price.



Fast, transparent booking

A sticky book bar with the real per-night price.

Target metrics: stay findability > 85% · booking completion > 90% · SUS > 80 · price-clarity rating ↑.

10 user interviews

Survey — 55 respondents

Competitive audit — Airbnb, Booking, Hopper

Journey mapping

Key findings

1 Inspiration comes before criteria

People browse to dream first, then narrow — discovery must feel visual and curated.

2 Photos + ratings win trust

Real imagery and review counts are the biggest confidence drivers on the detail page.

3 Amenities decide ties

Wi-Fi, pool, breakfast — the deciding details when comparing two stays.

4 Hidden fees destroy trust

A price that changes at checkout is the fastest way to lose the booking.

**Nisha Verma**

28 · Consultant · spontaneous traveler

"I decide to travel on a Thursday for the weekend. I want inspiration and a fast, honest booking."

GOALS

- Discover great stays quickly
- Book in minutes on mobile

FRUSTRATIONS

- Overwhelming, samey listings
- Prices that change at checkout

**Tom & Cara**

33 · planning a couples' getaway

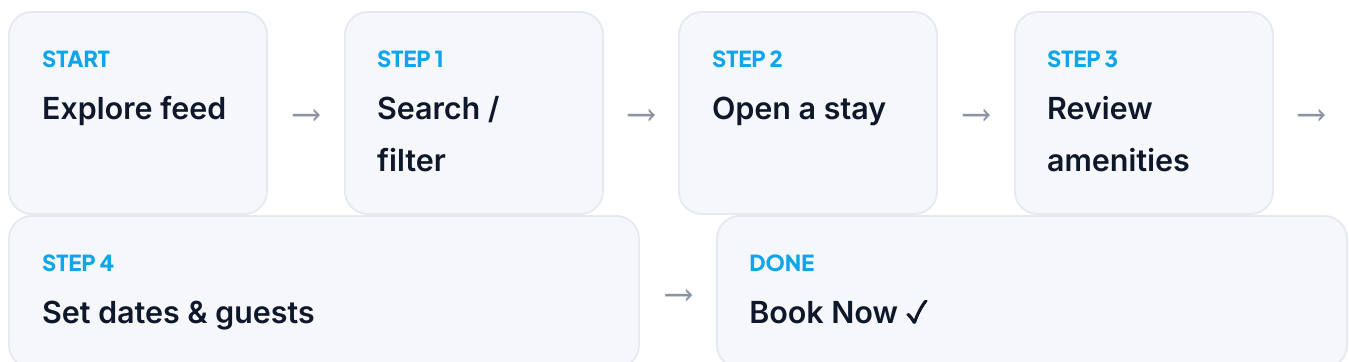
"We compare a lot before we commit — show us amenities and the real total so we can just decide."

GOALS

- Compare amenities & ratings easily
- See the honest total up front

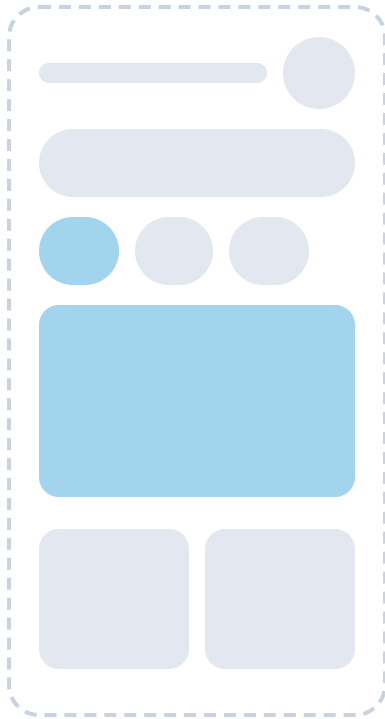
FRUSTRATIONS

- Fee surprises & unclear inclusions
- Long, fiddly booking forms

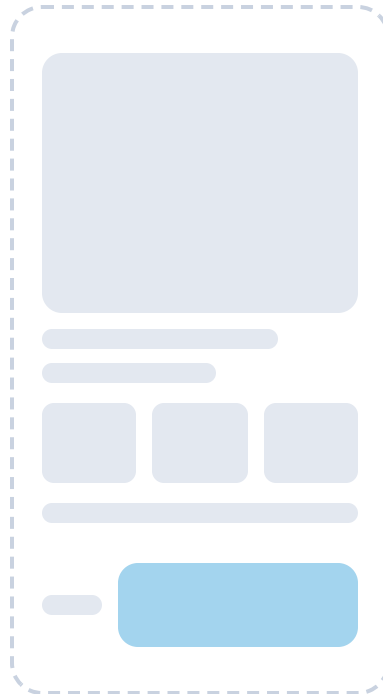


06 Wireframes

Low-fi prioritised a visual, curated Explore feed and a detail page that answers doubts above the sticky book bar.



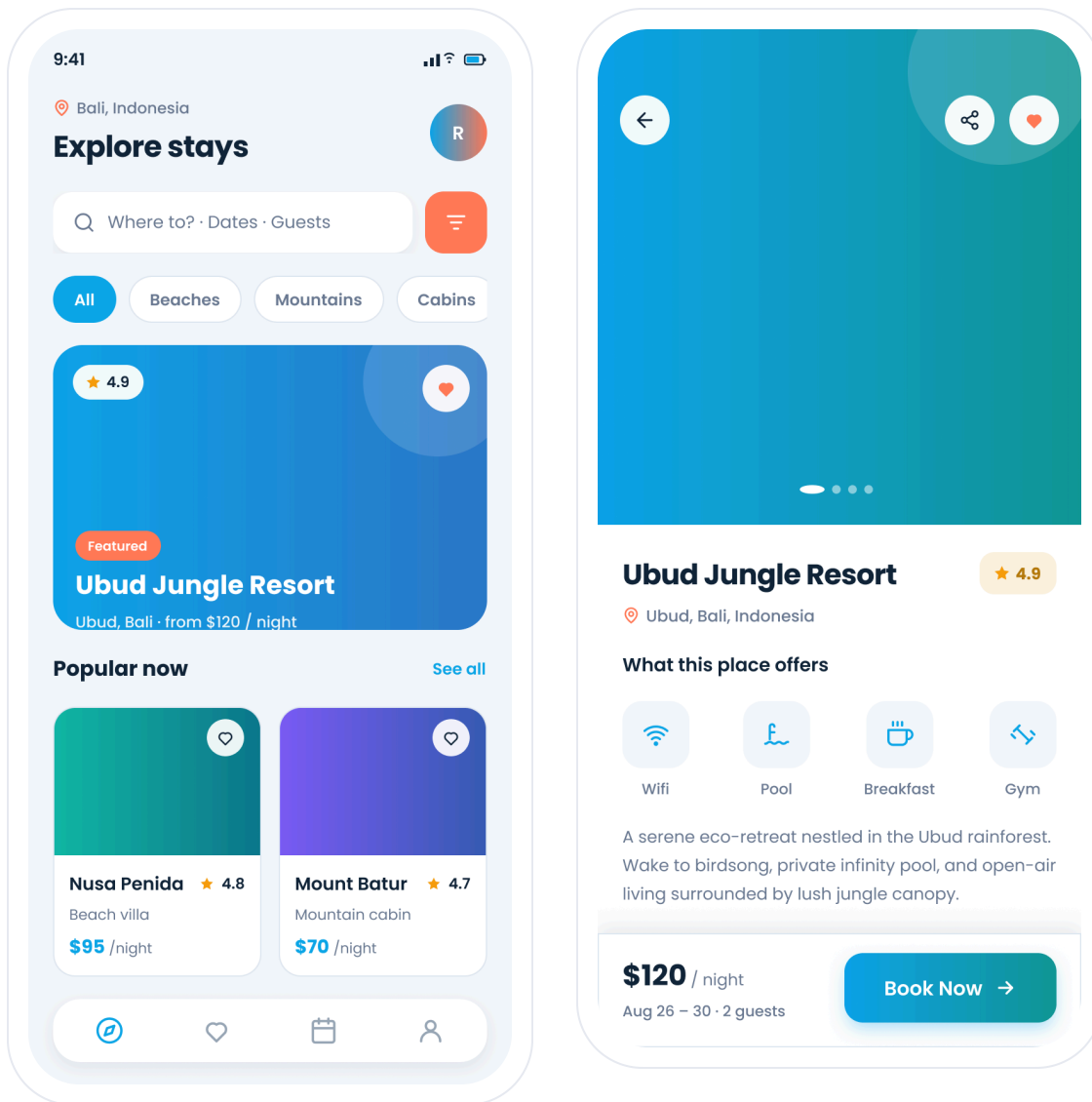
Explore — search, chips, featured + cards



Detail — hero, amenities, sticky Book

Hi-Fi Design & Prototype

Discovery leads with a bold featured card and category chips; the detail page builds trust with a photo gallery, ratings and an amenities grid — with an honest per-night total pinned to a sticky Book bar.



Explore & hotel detail — high-fidelity screens

Key design decisions



Featured hero + chips

Inspiration first; filtering is one tap away, not the whole screen.



Amenities grid

Scannable icons answer the deciding "does it have...?" questions instantly.



Transparent sticky book bar

The real price/night stays visible so there's no surprise at checkout.

Usability Testing

6 participants, unmoderated (Maze) + follow-up interviews.

Tasks: (1) "Find a highly-rated beach stay." (2) "Book it for 2 guests."

METRIC	TARGET	RESULT
Stay findability	> 85%	91%
Booking completion	> 90%	94%
System Usability Scale	> 80	85
Price-clarity rating (1–5)	↑	4.6

What testing changed

ITERATION 1

Users wanted the total before committing to the booking screen. → Surfaced the **per-night price on the sticky bar** earlier in the flow.

ITERATION 2

Date & guest selection was easy to miss. → Combined **"Dates · Guests"** into the **search summary** and made it a clear, tappable field.

09

Results & Impact

94%

booking task
completion

91%

found a matching
stay quickly

85

SUS score

4.6/5

price
transparency
rating

10

Reflection & Next Steps

Leading with **emotion and imagery** — then letting filters follow — matched how people actually plan trips. And nothing built trust like **an honest price shown early**; transparency was a UX feature, not just a policy.

Next: saved wishlists & trip boards, map-based discovery, and flexible-date price views for spontaneous travelers like Nisha.

UX Research

Journey Mapping

Visual Design

Interaction Design

Usability Testing